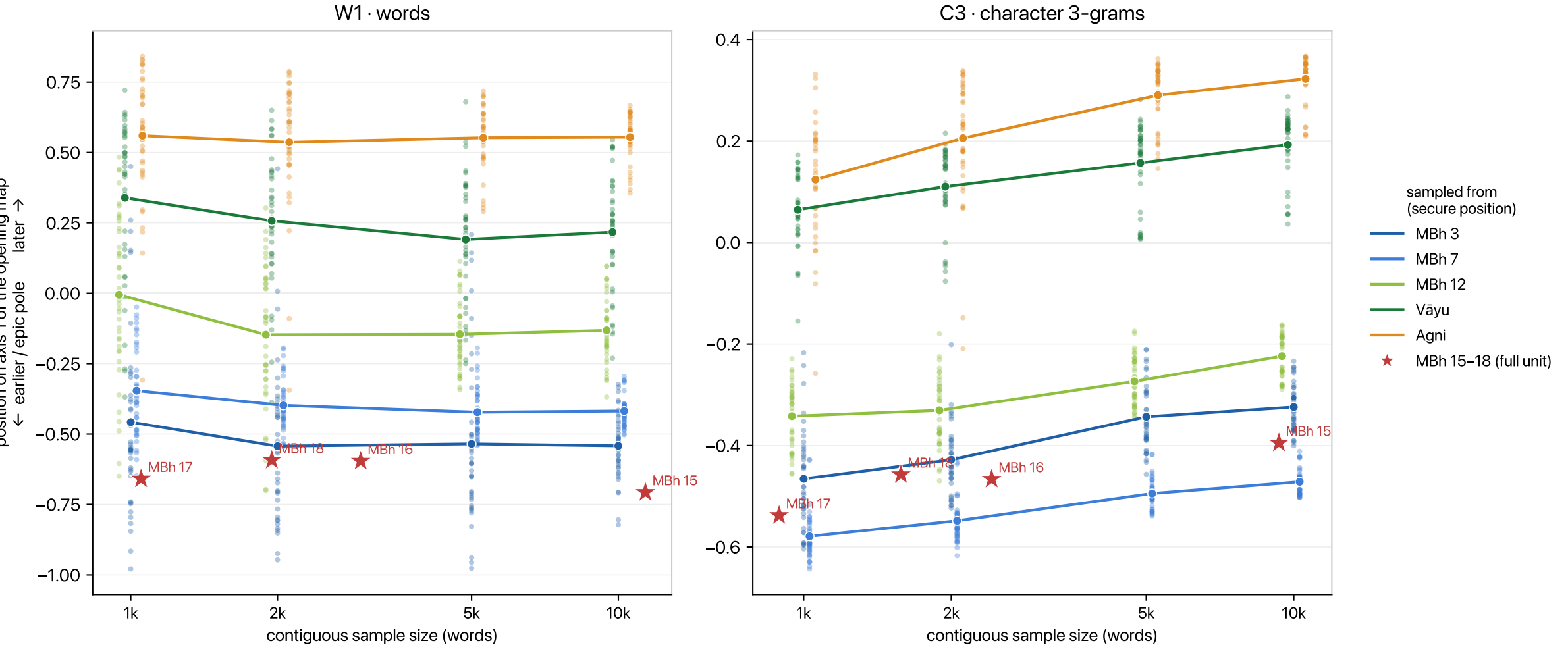


Why do the last Parvans of the Mahābhārata land at the epic pole? Can the length be the reason?

Random contiguous windows of securely-placed texts (MBh 3/7/12, Vāyu, Agni), each pushed through the identical pipeline and placed on the opening map. Two failure modes converge on the same length: the 3-gram lens drifts systematically leftward as the window shrinks, while the word lens keeps its mean but scatters so widely that single short windows reach the epic pole. The closing parvans (red) are single draws that small — MBh 16–18 sit inside the 1–2k scatter; only MBh 15, four times longer, stands apart.



Yet length is not the whole story: merged into one ~17k-word unit the closing parvans stay at the pole.
So the age of the material that might have been *added* could be old, after all? Something to consider...